

C++ Course

Materials for Students

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Chapter 1

Introduction

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This ebook is the first English draft based on the Polish C++ learning materials. The Polish version remains the source of truth for now. The English version starts with the course structure, learning path, and translation plan.

The full course is organized from environment setup and C++ basics to functions, arrays, strings, files, exceptions, object-oriented programming, STL, build systems, testing, and final projects.

Chapter 2

English Version Plan

2.1 Goal

The English edition should become a downloadable version of the C++ course for students who want to learn from the same material as the Polish course.

The first release should focus on readability and navigation. The code examples can stay close to the Polish repository at the beginning, while explanations, chapter introductions, exercises, and project descriptions are translated in batches.

2.2 Learning Path

1. `00-start` - development environment, compiler, editor, Git, and CMake.
2. `01-basics` - first program, input/output, types, variables, and operators.
3. `02-control-flow-loops` - conditions, `switch`, loops, `break`, `continue`.
4. `03-functions-arrays-strings` - functions, arrays, matrices, and strings.
5. `04-pointers-references-memory` - addresses, pointers, references, and safe memory habits.
6. `05-files-exceptions` - text files, validation, and exceptions.
7. `06-oop` - classes, objects, constructors, encapsulation, inheritance, and operators.
8. `07-stl-data-structures` - STL containers, algorithms, maps, stacks, queues, and lists.
9. `08-project-build-tests` - multi-file projects, build scripts, tests, and CI.
10. `09-modern-cpp` - selected modern C++ features, lambdas, move semantics, namespaces, and threads.
11. `10-projects` - final project topics, grading checklists, and project planning.

2.3 Translation Batches

2.3.1 Batch 1

- Main repository introduction - draft added.
- Ebook front matter - draft added.
- `00-start` - first English chapter added.
- `01-basics` - first English chapter added.

2.3.2 Batch 2

- `02-control-flow-loops` - first English chapter added.
- Bridge exercise: minimum, maximum, and average - included in the chapter.

2.3.3 Batch 3

- `03-functions-arrays-strings`.
- Bridge exercise: GADERYPOLUKI cipher.

2.3.4 Batch 4

- 04-pointers-references-memory.
- 05-files-exceptions.
- 06-oop.
- Bridge exercise: figures and polymorphism.

2.3.5 Batch 5

- 07-stl-data-structures.
- 08-project-build-tests.
- Bridge exercise: RPN calculator.

2.3.6 Batch 6

- 09-modern-cpp.
- 10-projects.
- Project checklist and grading card.

2.4 Editorial Rules

- Keep the English text simple and practical.
- Do not translate code identifiers unless the example itself is rewritten.
- Prefer short paragraphs and clear section titles.
- Keep exercises close to the Polish version, but adjust wording for an English-speaking student.
- Do not include archive materials in the ebook.
- Keep the Polish and English ebook versions buildable by the same script.

2.5 YouTube Support

The first bilingual video format should be short quizzes:

- Polish question first.
- English question second.
- One C++ concept per video.
- Link to the repository and both ebook downloads in the description.

Example:

C++ Quiz #1

What will this program print?

```
int x = 5;
std::cout << x++ << " " << x;
```

- A) 5 5
- B) 5 6
- C) 6 6

Answer: B) 5 6, because postfix `x++` returns the current value first and increments the variable afterwards.

2.6 First Downloadable English Draft

The first downloadable English file should be marked clearly as a draft:

- title: C++ Course
- version: 0.1.0-en
- scope: plan, learning path, and translation roadmap
- output files:

- `ebook/download/cpp-course-en.pdf`
- `ebook/download/cpp-course-en.epub`

Chapter 3

00 - Start

This chapter prepares the technical environment for learning C++. It is meant for students who are starting with a compiler, code editor, terminal, Git, and simple project structure.

3.1 Learning Goals

After this chapter you should be able to:

- explain what a C++ compiler does,
- compile and run a simple `.cpp` file,
- use a terminal for basic commands,
- open and edit source files in Visual Studio Code or another editor,
- understand why Git is useful during programming exercises,
- understand the role of `CMakeLists.txt` in larger projects,
- move safely to the first C++ programming chapter.

3.2 What You Need

You need:

- a C++ compiler with C++17 support,
- a text editor or IDE,
- a terminal,
- Git,
- access to this repository.

On macOS and Linux, the compiler is often available as `c++`, `clang++`, or `g++`. On Windows, students usually use MSYS2, Visual Studio Build Tools, or an IDE configured by the teacher.

3.3 First Compiler Check

Open a terminal and run:

```
c++ --version
```

If the command prints compiler information, you can continue. If it says that the command is missing, install a compiler before moving forward.

3.4 First Program

Create a file named `hello.cpp`:

```
#include <iostream>
```



```
int main() {  
    std::cout << "Hello, C++!" << std::endl;  
    return 0;  
}
```

Compile it:

```
c++ -std=c++17 -Wall -Wextra -pedantic hello.cpp -o hello
```

Run it:

```
./hello
```

Expected output:

```
Hello, C++!
```

3.5 Editor

Use an editor that lets you:

- open folders,
- edit `.cpp` files,
- open an integrated terminal,
- see compiler errors clearly.

Visual Studio Code is a practical default for beginners, but the course does not depend on one specific editor.

3.6 Git Basics

Git helps you save progress and review changes. For this course, the most important commands are:

```
git status  
git add file.cpp  
git commit -m "Describe the change"
```

At the beginning, treat Git as a history of your learning steps. Commit small, working changes.

3.7 CMake in One Sentence

CMake is a build configuration tool. In small exercises you can compile one file manually. In larger projects, CMake or a build script describes how many source files should be compiled together.

3.8 Student Checklist

Before going to the next chapter, make sure you can:

- open a terminal,
- check the compiler version,
- compile `hello.cpp`,
- run the generated program,
- explain what source file and executable mean,
- check Git status in a repository.

3.9 Next Step

Go to chapter 01 - Basics and write your first simple console programs.

Chapter 4

01 - C++ Basics

This chapter is the first programming block of the course. It introduces the structure of a C++ program, input and output, basic data types, variables, operators, and simple console tasks.

4.1 Learning Goals

After this chapter you should be able to:

- describe the role of an algorithm, a program, and the `main` function,
- write, compile, and run a simple C++ program,
- use `std::cout`, `std::cin`, and `std::getline`,
- choose basic data types for a simple problem,
- declare and initialize variables,
- perform simple calculations,
- format basic text output,
- solve small console exercises.

4.2 Minimal Program Structure

Most beginner programs in this course start like this:

```
#include <iostream>

int main() {
    std::cout << "Hello" << std::endl;
    return 0;
}
```

Important parts:

- `#include <iostream>` makes console input/output available,
- `int main()` is the starting point of the program,
- statements inside `{ }` are executed in order,
- `return 0;` means the program finished successfully.

4.3 Output

Use `std::cout` to print text:

```
#include <iostream>

int main() {
    std::cout << "C++ basics" << std::endl;
```

```
    std::cout << "Second line" << std::endl;
}
```

`std::endl` ends the current line.

4.4 Input

Use `std::cin` to read a value:

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>

int main() {
    std::string name;

    std::cout << "Your name: ";
    std::cin >> name;

    std::cout << "Hello, " << name << "!" << std::endl;
}
```

Use `std::getline` when you want to read a full line with spaces:

```
#include <iostream>
#include <string>

int main() {
    std::string fullName;

    std::cout << "Full name: ";
    std::getline(std::cin, fullName);

    std::cout << "Hello, " << fullName << "!" << std::endl;
}
```

4.5 Basic Types

Common beginner types:

Type	Example use
<code>int</code>	whole numbers
<code>double</code>	decimal numbers
<code>char</code>	one character
<code>bool</code>	true or false
<code>std::string</code>	text

Example:

```
int age = 20;
double price = 19.99;
bool active = true;
std::string city = "Krakow";
```

4.6 Simple Calculation

```
#include <iostream>

int main() {
```

```

double a = 0.0;
double b = 0.0;

std::cout << "First number: ";
std::cin >> a;

std::cout << "Second number: ";
std::cin >> b;

std::cout << "Sum: " << a + b << std::endl;
std::cout << "Product: " << a * b << std::endl;
}

```

4.7 Formatting Output

For decimal precision, use `<iomanip>`:

```

#include <iomanip>
#include <iostream>

int main() {
    double value = 10.0 / 3.0;
    std::cout << std::fixed << std::setprecision(2);
    std::cout << value << std::endl;
}

```

Expected output:

3.33

4.8 Common Mistakes

- forgetting `#include <iostream>`,
- missing semicolon at the end of a statement,
- using `int` when the result should contain decimals,
- mixing `std::cin >> value` and `std::getline` without understanding how input is buffered,
- ignoring compiler warnings.

4.9 Practice Tasks

1. Print your name, city, and favorite programming topic.
2. Read two integers and print their sum, difference, and product.
3. Read a rectangle width and height, then print its area.
4. Read a temperature in Celsius and print the value in Fahrenheit.
5. Read a full name with spaces and print a greeting.

4.10 Student Checklist

Before moving to control flow and loops, make sure you can:

- write a minimal C++ program,
- compile it with `-std=c++17 -Wall -Wextra -pedantic`,
- read one value from the user,
- read one full line from the user,
- choose between `int`, `double`, `bool`, and `std::string`,
- format a decimal number with two digits after the decimal point.

4.11 Next Step

The next topic is control flow: `if`, `else`, `switch`, and loops.

Chapter 5

02 - Control Flow and Loops

This chapter teaches how a program makes decisions and repeats instructions. These tools are necessary for almost every non-trivial console program.

5.1 Learning Goals

After this chapter you should be able to:

- use `if`, `else if`, and `else`,
- use comparison and logical operators,
- use `switch` for simple menu-like choices,
- use the conditional operator `?:` in simple expressions,
- write loops with `for`, `while`, and `do while`,
- choose the right loop type for a problem,
- use `break` and `continue` in simple cases,
- solve tasks that require decisions and repetition.

5.2 Conditions

Use `if` when the program should execute code only in some situations:

```
#include <iostream>

int main() {
    int age = 0;

    std::cout << "Age: ";
    std::cin >> age;

    if (age >= 18) {
        std::cout << "Adult" << std::endl;
    } else {
        std::cout << "Minor" << std::endl;
    }
}
```

Common comparison operators:

Operator	Meaning
<code>==</code>	equal
<code>!=</code>	not equal
<code><</code>	less than
<code><=</code>	less than or equal

Operator	Meaning
>	greater than
>=	greater than or equal

Logical operators:

Operator	Meaning
&&	and
	or
!	not

5.3 Multiple Conditions

Use `else if` when there are several possible ranges or categories:

```
#include <iostream>

int main() {
    int points = 0;

    std::cout << "Points: ";
    std::cin >> points;

    if (points >= 90) {
        std::cout << "Very good" << std::endl;
    } else if (points >= 60) {
        std::cout << "Passed" << std::endl;
    } else {
        std::cout << "Failed" << std::endl;
    }
}
```

5.4 switch

Use `switch` for simple choices based on one value:

```
#include <iostream>

int main() {
    int option = 0;

    std::cout << "1. Add\n";
    std::cout << "2. Remove\n";
    std::cout << "Option: ";
    std::cin >> option;

    switch (option) {
        case 1:
            std::cout << "Add selected" << std::endl;
            break;
        case 2:
            std::cout << "Remove selected" << std::endl;
            break;
        default:
            std::cout << "Unknown option" << std::endl;
    }
}
```

```

        break;
    }
}

```

Remember `break`. Without it, execution continues into the next case.

5.5 for Loop

Use `for` when you know how many times the loop should run:

```

#include <iostream>

int main() {
    for (int i = 1; i <= 5; ++i) {
        std::cout << i << std::endl;
    }
}

```

Typical uses:

- counting from 1 to `n`,
- summing numbers,
- printing a table,
- iterating over an index range.

5.6 while Loop

Use `while` when the loop depends on a condition that may change during input:

```

#include <iostream>

int main() {
    int number = 0;

    while (number != 5) {
        std::cout << "Enter 5 to stop: ";
        std::cin >> number;
    }
}

```

This loop may execute zero times if the condition is false at the beginning.

5.7 do while Loop

Use `do while` when the body should run at least once:

```

#include <iostream>

int main() {
    int option = 0;

    do {
        std::cout << "1. Continue\n";
        std::cout << "0. Exit\n";
        std::cout << "Option: ";
        std::cin >> option;
    } while (option != 0);
}

```

This is useful for simple console menus.

5.8 break and continue

`break` exits a loop:

```
for (int i = 1; i <= 10; ++i) {
    if (i == 5) {
        break;
    }
    std::cout << i << std::endl;
}
```

`continue` skips the rest of the current iteration:

```
for (int i = 1; i <= 10; ++i) {
    if (i % 2 == 0) {
        continue;
    }
    std::cout << i << std::endl;
}
```

5.9 Common Mistakes

- writing `=` instead of `==` in a condition,
- adding an accidental semicolon after `if` or `while`,
- forgetting `break` in `switch`,
- creating an infinite loop because the loop variable never changes,
- dividing by zero when no valid input was provided,
- using `for` for input that should end based on user command.

5.10 Bridge Exercise: Minimum, Maximum, and Average

Write a console program that reads real numbers from the user and calculates:

- minimum value,
- maximum value,
- arithmetic average,
- number of valid values.

The user should be able to finish input with a portable text command, for example `q`, `end`, or an empty line.

Example session:

```
Enter a number or q to finish: 10
Enter a number or q to finish: -2.5
Enter a number or q to finish: 4.5
Enter a number or q to finish: q
```

```
Count: 3
Minimum: -2.5
Maximum: 10
Average: 4
```

5.10.1 Requirements

The program should:

- use C++17,
- use a `while` or `do while` loop,
- store the sum in a `double`,
- count valid values,

- update minimum and maximum after each valid value,
- detect invalid input,
- avoid division by zero when no numbers were entered,
- compile with `-Wall -Wextra -pedantic`.

5.10.2 Suggested Work Plan

1. Write a loop that reads text until the user enters `q`.
2. Add a counter for valid numbers.
3. Add sum and average calculation.
4. Add minimum and maximum.
5. Add a message for the empty data case.
6. Add invalid input handling, for example for `abc`.

5.10.3 Check Scenarios

1. Enter 10, -2.5, 4.5, then `q`.
2. Enter only one number and check that minimum, maximum, and average are the same.
3. Finish without entering any number and check the message.
4. Enter invalid text such as `abc` and check that the program asks again.
5. Enter several negative numbers and verify minimum and maximum.

5.11 Practice Tasks

1. Read a number and print whether it is positive, negative, or zero.
2. Read a menu option and handle it with `switch`.
3. Print numbers from 1 to 100 with a `for` loop.
4. Sum numbers from 1 to `n`.
5. Read numbers until the user enters 0.
6. Print a multiplication table.
7. Skip even numbers using `continue`.
8. Stop searching when a target value is found using `break`.

5.12 Student Checklist

Before moving to functions, arrays, and strings, make sure you can:

- write an `if/else` condition,
- use comparison and logical operators,
- use a `switch` with `break`,
- choose between `for`, `while`, and `do while`,
- write a loop that depends on user input,
- explain when `break` and `continue` are useful,
- solve the minimum, maximum, and average bridge exercise.